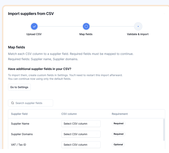
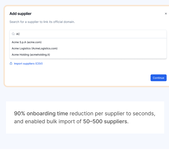
Case Study

Scaling Supplier Onboarding for Enterprise TPRM

Transforming supplier onboarding from a manual, repetitive process into a flexible system — enabling both bulk import for scale and a streamlined single-supplier flow for everyday use.

Bulk import & manual onboarding flows





90% onboarding time reduction per supplier to seconds, and enabled bulk import of 50–500 suppliers.

PROBLEM

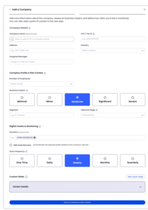
Onboarding didn't scale with customer reality

Supplier onboarding is the entry point to all TPRM workflows — compliance, audits, documents, and risk monitoring.

However, the experience broke down at scale:

- Suppliers had to be added one-by-one through a long form
- No support for importing existing vendor portfolios
- Unclear required vs optional fields slowed even simple entries

For enterprise customers managing 50–500 suppliers, onboarding became a blocker — not a starting point.



EVIDENCE

Onboarding as a bottleneck

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The problem surfaced through two signals:

- **Behavioral observation in Clarity**
- **Repeated feedback from sales and marketing conversations with customers evaluating the platform.**

Users consistently behaved as if supplier onboarding was an administrative task to get through, not a workflow that supported progress.

Enterprise customers were already managing suppliers in spreadsheets, yet the platform required one-by-one entry. Even for single suppliers, unclear field requirements created hesitation and slowed completion.

This created both a **usability problem** and a **business problem**: onboarding delayed time-to-value and weakened enterprise readiness.

DESIGN APPROACH

From manual input to scalable onboarding

I reframed onboarding as a system that needs to support both scale and flexibility.

Rather than optimizing a single flow, the goal was to align the experience with how users actually manage supplier data.

This led to two complementary solutions:

- **Bulk import** for large supplier portfolios
- **Simplified** single-supplier flow for everyday use

Bulk import is not just about speed — it is controlled onboarding at scale.

THE SOLUTION

A flexible onboarding system

The final design introduces two aligned entry points:

- Bulk import → for scale
- Guided form → for individual suppliers

Both flows share the same structure and data model, ensuring consistency across the platform.

The system supports two realities:

- Onboarding hundreds of suppliers at once
- Adding a single supplier quickly and correctly

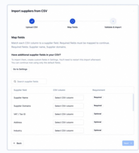
01. Bulk import for scalability

Many customers already manage suppliers in spreadsheets. The solution aligns with this behavior while introducing guardrails to prevent incorrect data ingestion.

Flow:

- Upload supplier list (CSV / Excel)
- Map columns to platform fields
- Validate before creation
- Resolve errors and confirm import

A downloadable template removes ambiguity and guides correct formatting.



Key design decisions

- **Auto-mapping fields**
  Normalizes column names and pre-matches fields to reduce setup time
- **Required field gating**
  Prevents users from continuing without mapping critical fields (name + domain)
- **Validation before creation**
  Ensures incorrect data does not enter the system
- **Re-upload instead of inline editing**
  Designed for real-world CSV errors, which are usually systemic rather than isolated

In enterprise onboarding, the biggest risk is not uploading data — it is importing incorrect data.

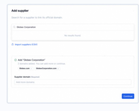
02.Simplified single-supplier flow

Bulk import solves scale, but users still need to add suppliers individually.

The manual flow was redesigned to reduce friction and ambiguity:

- Clear distinction between required and optional fields
- Structured sections (company, risk context, monitoring)
- Preselected defaults to reduce effort
- Improved visual hierarchy and scanability

This reduces cognitive load and enables faster completion without sacrificing flexibility.



OUTCOME

From manual entry to scalable workflow

01 Enabled self-service onboarding for enterprise customers importing 50–500 suppliers

02 Reduced manual add time from ~3 minutes to under 30 seconds

03 Reduced friction through clear structure and defaults

04 Aligned onboarding with existing spreadsheet-based workflows

> **System insight**
> *Scalability in enterprise products is not just about speed — it is about aligning systems with how users already manage their data.*
>
> *By supporting both bulk and manual entry, the onboarding experience adapts to different workflows while maintaining consistency and control.*

ROLE OF THE SYSTEM

Onboarding as a system layer

The onboarding flow is not an isolated feature — it is the entry point into the entire TPRM system.

Accurate supplier data directly feeds into:

01 Compliance & Policy

02 Audit workflows

03 Document management

04 Cyber posture monitoring

05 Risk evaluation

Designing onboarding as a structured and scalable system ensures that downstream processes start with reliable, consistent data.

Interested in building complex B2B systems together?

Get in touch →